TA studio brief — One change, named before you make it

Pathway: TRACK · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How does naming one specific compositional change before touching the page lead to stronger refinement?

TA practical setup & focus

Check that every pupil has written or ticked their intended change on their log card before handing out the black brush pens and white highlights.

Studio kit: Week 4 identity artworks, Week 3 plans, refinement log cards, black brush pens, white gouache/chalk, coloured pencils, oil pastels

Key words to prompt

• refinement: A focused, deliberate adjustment that sharpens clarity, tone, or balance.

• intention: Knowing and stating the exact visual effect you want before making a mark.

• edge quality: How crisp, bold, or soft the boundary is between two shapes.

• accent: A small touch of bright highlight or deep dark that pulls the eye to the focal point.

• audit: Checking your work honestly against your original design goals.

Supported route steps

1. Look at your Week 4 piece from arm's length and tick one target on your refinement card ('Sharpen outline' or 'Add bright highlights').

2. Point on your artwork to the exact place where you will make the change.

3. Use a thick black pen or white chalk pencil to carry out that one improvement neatly.

4. Complete the log stem: 'I changed the ___ and now my piece looks ___.'

Check: Target ticked before action, refinement applied cleanly, and log stem completed.

Review & exit support

Exit question: Why do we stop working as soon as our one or two named refinements are complete?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review a short clip on teaching intentional refinement and preventing pupils from overworking finished pieces.